

Final Travel Guide · v4

THE ROUTE

A 12-day journey through the Swiss Alps and Italian heartland — meticulously planned with every train, meal, museum ticket, and sunset accounted for.

12

DAYS

8

CITIES

11

NIGHTS

2

TRAVELERS

6

HOTELS BOOKED

✈️2

FLIGHTS BOOKED

□□

HALF FARE CARD

3

ITALY BOOKED

Trip Overview

✈ Flights

OutboundSWISS LX155 BOM 00:40 → ZRH 06:20 | PNR: Z5DY9C | ₹77,625

ReturnGulf Air GF26/56 FCO 12:40 → BAH → BOM 05:10+1 | PNR: UYWIKY | ₹69,372

Tickets7242907276239/40 · 0724857463386/7

🏨 Booked Hotels

Oct 1INSIDE FIVE Zurich | ₹12,375 | ⏳ Register 24h before!

Oct 2Hotel Alpina Lucerne | ₹18,748 | ⏳ 2 min from Chapel Bridge

Oct 3Harder Minerva Interlaken | ₹21,562 | ⏳ Free cancel till Sep 19

Oct 4Hotel Demò Milan | ₹14,941 | ⏳ Via Tonale 14, near Centrale. Non-refundable.

Oct 5Hotel Palme Monterosso | ₹18,678 | ⏳ Via IV Novembre 10, Old Town. 9.1/10.

Oct 6-7Cardinal of Florence Florence | ₹36,691 | ⏳ Borgo Pinti 5, San Marco. Roof terrace.

Budget Snapshot

Spent₹2,74,493 (flights + all 6 hotels)

Est. Remaining~₹2.5-3.5L (Rome hotel/food/trains/tickets)

Est. Grand Total~₹5.5-6.5L (₹2.8-3.2L/pp)

🚨 URGENT: Book This First!

Last Supper — Late Jun/Jul 2026 · cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it · €15/pp

Trains — Interlaken → Milan EC 61, Florence → Rome Frecciarossa (Jul)

Half Fare Card — swissrailways.com · CHF 120/pp · Before Sep

Full Booking Timeline

PRIOR	ITEM	WHEN	COST	LINK
URGENT	🏠 Last Supper — Oct 4, 15:00	Late Jun/Jul	€15	cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it
Jul-Aug	🚆 Interlaken → Milan EC 61 (09:33)	Jul	From €23	trenitalia.com
Jul-Aug	🚆 Florence → Rome Frecciarossa (16:00)	Jul	From €14.90	trenitalia.com
Jul-Aug	🚆 Milan → Monterosso (10:35)	Jul-Aug	~€29	trenitalia.com
Jul-Aug	🎨 Borghese Gallery — Oct 10, 15:00	Jul-Aug	~€18	borghesegallery.com
Aug-Sep	🏛 Uffizi — Oct 7, 08:15	Aug-Sep	~€40	uffizi.it
Aug-Sep	🎨 Accademia — Oct 7, 10:30	Aug-Sep	~€12	galleriaaccademiafirenze.it
Aug-Sep	🏛 Brunelleschi Pass — Oct 7, 11:30	Aug-Sep	€30	duomo.firenze.it
Aug-Sep	🏛 Vatican Museums — Oct 9, 13:00	Aug-Sep	~€22	tickets.museivaticani.va
Sep	🏟 Colosseum — Oct 10, 08:30	Sep	€18-24	colosseo.it
Before Sep	🏠 Half Fare Card (2x, start Oct 1)	Anytime	CHF 120	swissrailways.com
Walk-up	🏛 St. Peter's Dome — Oct 9	Same day	€10	—
Walk-up	🚆 Leonardo Express — Oct 12	Same day	€14	Station machines

Half Fare Card — Cost Breakdown

ITEM	FULL PRICE	WITH HFC (50% OFF)
HFC Card (one-time, valid 30 days)	—	CHF 120
Oct 1: Airport train + Zurich city transport	~CHF 20	~CHF 10
Oct 2: Zurich → Lucerne + Lake cruise	~CHF 63	~CHF 31.50
Oct 2: Pilatus (*if chosen)	~CHF 72	~CHF 36
Oct 3: Lucerne → Interlaken + Grindelwald	~CHF 51	~CHF 25.50
🏠 Jungfrauojch	CHF 261.20	CHF 130.60
Oct 4: Swiss portion to Domodossola	~CHF 30	~CHF 15
TOTAL per person (with HFC, relaxed)		~CHF 332
TOTAL per person (with HFC + Pilatus)		~CHF 368

DAY 01

Thursday, October 1, 2026
☐ INSIDE FIVE City Apartments · Motorenstrasse 11

☐ **About Zurich**

Zurich is Switzerland's largest city (~430,000) and global financial hub, yet its medieval Old Town (Altstadt) is one of Europe's best-preserved. Founded as the Roman customs post *Turicum* in 15 BC, it later joined the Swiss Confederacy in 1351. Today, it consistently ranks among the world's most livable cities. The city straddles the Limmat River where it meets Lake Zurich, with the iconic twin-towered Grossmünster dominating the skyline.

☐ **Did You Know?**

- The **Grossmünster** was founded by Charlemagne himself — legend says his horse stumbled on the graves of the city's patron saints, Felix and Regula, and he ordered the church built on that spot.
- **Fraumünster's** Chagall windows (1970) are among the only religious works by the Russian-French modernist — he created them at age 83!
- The **Lindenhof** hill was the site of a Roman fort — and later where Swiss women dressed as soldiers in 1292 to trick an invading Habsburg army into retreating.
- Zurich's **Sprüngli** on Paradeplatz has been making luxury chocolates since 1836. Their Luxemburgerli macarons are legendary.

☐ **Where to Eat**

Place	Type	Cost
Sprüngli (Paradeplatz)	☐ Breakfast/café	CHF 12-18
Zeughauskeller	☐ Zürcher Geschnetzeltles	CHF 25-40
Niederdorf alleys	☐ Varied cuisines	CHF 15-25
Coop/Migros	☐ Budget ready meals	CHF 5-8

✂ **Safety & Tips**

- **INSIDE FIVE:** No front desk. Register **24h before** + passport upload
- Zurich is one of the **safest cities** in Europe. Low pickpocket risk.
- Skip Kunsthaus if jet-lagged — focus on Old Town walking tour
- ZRH Airport → HB train: every 8-10 min, 14 min, platforms below Arrivals

☐ **Fraumünster Church**

Chagall's five stained-glass windows (1970) · CHF 5 · 30 min

☐ **Grossmünster + Tower**

Charlemagne's church · city's best view · CHF 5 · 1h

☐ **Lindenhof Viewpoint**

Roman fort site · Old Town panorama · FREE · 30 min

☐ **Lake Zurich**

Alpine views · promenade · swans · FREE · 1h

☐ **Day Timeline**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
06:20	☐ LX155 lands	Zurich Airport — Schengen arrival, clear customs ~30 min	—
07:10 → 07:24	☐ Airport → ZRH HB	Train every 8-10 min, 14 min ride, platforms below Arrivals	50% HFC
08:00 → 08:45	☐ Breakfast @ Sprüngli	Paradeplatz — luxury chocolate café, Luxemburgerli	CHF 12-18
09:00 → 09:30	☐ Lindenhof Viewpoint	Panoramic Old Town + river views. Former Roman fort.	FREE
10:00 → 10:30	☐ Fraumünster Church	Chagall's windows — blue, green, red themes: Christ, prophets, Zion	CHF 5
10:30 → 11:30	☐ Grossmünster + Tower	Twin towers legend from Charlemagne. 187-step tower climb.	CHF 5
15:00	☐ Check-in INSIDE FIVE	⚠ Must register 24h before + upload passport	—
16:00 → 17:00	☐ Lake Zurich walk	Promenade towards Zürichhorn — perfect red-eye recovery	FREE
19:00+	☐ Dinner @ Niederdorf	Lively old-town alleys — reserve ahead	CHF 30-50

☐ **What Makes Each Place Special**

PLACE	WHY IT'S WORTH YOUR TIME
Fraumünster	Marc Chagall created the five stained-glass windows in 1970 at age 83 — they depict biblical scenes in his distinctive dreamlike blue, green, and red palette. The south transept window (blue) representing "Christ" is the most famous. Worth the CHF 5.
Grossmünster	According to legend, Charlemagne's horse stumbled on the graves of the city's patron saints and he ordered a church built. The twin towers are Zurich's most iconic silhouette. Climb for a 360° view of the city, lake, and Alps.
Lindenhof	This raised plateau was a Roman fort, then a medieval imperial palace, and even a 1292 battle site where Swiss women pranked retreating Habsburgs. Today it's the best free viewpoint.
Lake Zurich promenade	A car-free 3km lakeside walk. Alpine views on clear days, swans, and the perfect wind-down from a red-eye flight.

DAY 02

Friday, October 2, 2026
 ☐ Hotel Alpina · Frankenstrasse 6 (2 min from Chapel Bridge)

☐ **About Lucerne**
 Lucerne (Luzern) sits on the shores of Lake Lucerne (Vierwaldstättersee) with the Swiss Alps as a dramatic backdrop. Founded in 750 AD, it became a key stop on the Gotthard trade route. The Chapel Bridge (Kapellbrücke), Europe's oldest surviving wooden bridge, dates to 1333 and snakes across the Reuss River with 17th-century painted panels. The Lion Monument (1821) commemorates Swiss Guards killed during the French Revolution — Mark Twain called it "the most mournful and moving piece of stone in the world."

- ☐ **Did You Know?**
- The **Chapel Bridge** was nearly lost to a fire in 1993 — 78 of its 158 painted panels were destroyed. The surviving 80 originals are on display.
 - **Mt. Pilatus** is named after a legend that Pontius Pilate's body was thrown into a lake on the mountain, causing storms.
 - The **Lion Monument** was carved into a sandstone quarry by Danish sculptor Bertel Thorvaldsen. The dying lion is 10m long.
 - The **Musegg Wall** (1408) is one of the best-preserved medieval city walls in Switzerland. Four of nine towers are climbable.

☐ **Where to Eat**

Place	Type	Cost
Rathaus Brauerei	☐ Brewery + lake views	CHF 25-40
Wirtshaus Taube	☐ Swiss classics	CHF 20-35
Hotel Schweizerhof	☐ Lake terrace dining	CHF 30-50

- ✂ **Tips**
- **Pilatus timing:** Start by 12:00. Last cogwheel ~17:30
 - Pilatus Golden Round Trip = Bus → Gondola → Summit → Cogwheel → Boat
 - Chapel Bridge lit at 21:00 is stunning — don't miss night walk
 - Hotel Alpina check-in from 14:00. Drop bags at 10:00

☐ **Morning + Evening (Fixed for both options)**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 08:45	☐ Breakfast	At INSIDE FIVE, then checkout. Leave bags.	CHF 10-15
09:10 → 09:51	☐ ZRH HB → Lucerne	SBB IR 70 — every 30 min, 41 min. Sit on left for lake glimpses.	50% HFC
10:15 → 10:45	☐ Chapel Bridge	Europe's oldest wooden bridge (1333). 17th-century painted panels tell Swiss history.	FREE
10:50 → 11:10	☐ Lion Monument	Mark Twain's "saddest piece of stone." Carved 1821. 10m dying lion.	FREE
11:15 → 11:45	☐ Old Town (Weinmarkt)	Medieval squares with painted facades.	FREE
19:00+	☐ Dinner	Lake promenade — reserve ahead. Swiss fondue!	CHF 35-50
21:00	☐ Chapel Bridge night	Bridge beautifully lit at night — ☐ top Lucerne moment	FREE

☐ **Afternoon: Choose Your Adventure**

☐ **OPTION A: Mt. Pilatus Golden Round Trip** (clear weather only)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
12:00 → 12:30	☐ Bus #1 → Kriens	From Lucerne station to gondola base	50% HFC
12:30 → 13:00	☐ Gondola → Pilatus Kulm	Panoramic ascent to 2,132m	~CHF 36
13:00 → 14:00	☐ Summit Views	Alpine panorama — 73 mountains visible on clear days	Incl.
14:00 → 14:40	☐ Cogwheel → Alpnachstad	Steepest cogwheel in the world (48% grade)!	50% HFC
15:00 → 16:15	☐ Boat → Lucerne	Scenic return across Lake Lucerne — ☐	50% HFC

☐ **OPTION B: Relaxed Lucerne + Lake Cruise** (any weather)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
12:12 → 13:00	☐ Cruise → Weggis	Lake Lucerne paddle steamer — 1h journey across the lake	50% HFC
13:00 → 13:40	☐ Explore Weggis	Charming lakeside village with mountain views	FREE
13:45 → 14:30	☐ Return cruise	45 min back to Lucerne	50% HFC
15:30 → 17:00	☐ Musegg Wall	9 medieval towers, city ramparts with panoramic views	FREE

DAY 03

Saturday, October 3, 2026
☐ Hotel Harder Minerva · Harderstrasse 15 (5 min from Interlaken Ost)

☐ About Interlaken & Jungfraujoch

Interlaken (literally “between lakes”) sits on a narrow strip of flatland between Lake Thun and Lake Brienz, surrounded by the Bernese Alps. It's the adventure capital of Switzerland. **Jungfraujoch** (3,454m / 11,332ft) is the highest railway station in Europe. The summit has the **Sphinx Observation Deck** (panoramic 360° views), the **Ice Palace** (tunnels carved 20m into the glacier), the **Aletsch Glacier** viewpoint (UNESCO World Heritage, longest Alpine glacier at 23km), and the **Liquor Chocolate Paradise** (don't miss the free samples!).

☐ Did You Know?

- The Jungfrau Railway opened in 1912 after **16 years** of construction through rock and glacier. Workers died blasting tunnels by hand.
- The summit station was originally only reachable via a 7km tunnel through the Eiger and Mönch mountains — you literally ride **inside** the mountain.
- The **Aletsch Glacier** is 23km long and contains 27 billion tons of ice. It's receding ~50m per year.
- The **Eiger Express** (opened 2020) cut the journey from Interlaken by 47 min. State-of-the-art 3S cable car with glass floors!

☐ Where to Eat

Place	Type	Cost
Hirschen (Old Town)	☐ Traditional Swiss	CHF 25-40
Hüsi Bierhaus	☐ Hearty meals	CHF 20-30
Jungfraujoch Panorama	☐ Summit dining (11:30-16:00)	CHF 20-35
Migros (near station)	☐ Quick lunch	CHF 10-15

< Survival Tips

- **Warm layers!** Jungfraujoch at 3,454m can be -5°C even in October
- Sit **RIGHT side** of Luzern-Interlaken Express for best lake views
- Last descent from Jungfraujoch ~16:45 — don't miss it!
- HFC: **CHF 130.60** vs CHF 195.90 with old STP — massive saving!

☐ Day Timeline

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 08:45	☐ Breakfast	Hotel Alpina + checkout	CHF 10-15
09:04 → 10:59	☐ Lucerne → Interlaken	Luzern-Interlaken Express via Brünig. Sit RIGHT — Lake Brienz views! No reservation needed.	50% HFC
11:00 → 11:15	☐ Drop bags	Harder Minerva, 5 min walk from station. Check-in from 15:00.	—
11:30 → 12:15	☐ Quick lunch	Grab-and-go from Migros or station bakery	CHF 15-25
12:32 → 13:04	☐ Interlaken → Grindelwald	32 min train to Grindelwald Terminal	50% HFC
13:04 → 13:19	☐ Eiger Express	15 min cable car to Eigergletscher (glass floor!)	Incl.
13:19 → 13:27	☐ Cogwheel	8 min through the tunnel inside the Eiger	Incl.
13:27 → 16:30	☐ JUNGFRAUJOCH	3h at the Top of Europe!	CHF 130.60
→ 16:30	☐ Sphinx Deck	360° panoramic view over Aletsch Glacier	Incl.
→	☐ Ice Palace	Tunnels carved 20m into the glacier	Incl.
→	☐ Plateau	Walk on the glacier (seasonal) + Swiss flag photo	Incl.
→	☐ Chocolate Paradise	Free Lindt samples at the highest chocolate shop!	FREE
16:30 → 17:25	↓ Descent	Jungfraujoch → Interlaken Ost (55 min)	Incl.
17:30 → 18:00	☐ Check-in	Harder Minerva — rest after the summit	—
19:00+	☐ Dinner	Reserve ahead — Hirschen or Hüsi Bierhaus	CHF 30-45

☐ Jungfraujoch Attractions (3 hours — allocate wisely)

ATTRACTION	TIME	WHY YOU CAN'T MISS IT
☐ Sphinx Observation Deck	40 min	360° view at 3,571m. Aletsch Glacier stretching 23km south. On a clear day, you can see into France, Germany, and Italy. Go first — best in morning but still spectacular at 13:30.
☐ Ice Palace	20 min	A labyrinth of tunnels carved 20m into the glacier. Blue-lit ice sculptures. Slippery! Temperature: -3°C inside.
☐ Alpine Sensation	15 min	A multimedia walk through the history of the Jungfrau Railway. Interactive displays. The story of 16 years of construction is inspiring.
☐ Plateau	30 min	Outdoor glacier terrace. Take the classic photo with the Swiss flag. Wear warm layers!

DAY 04

Sunday, October 4, 2026
☐ Hotel Demò · Via Tonale 14 (5 min from Centrale)

☐ **About Milan**

Milan (Milano) is Italy's financial and fashion capital, but its roots go back to 600 BC when the Insubri Celts founded Mediolanum. It became the capital of the Western Roman Empire in 286 AD, then flourished under the Sforza dukes during the Renaissance. Leonardo da Vinci spent 17 years here (1482-1499), creating *The Last Supper* and designing canals. The Duomo (started 1386, finished 1965!) is the largest church in Italy and 5th largest in the world. Every detail of Milan whispers power, art, and ambition.

☐ **Did You Know?**

- **The Last Supper** took Leonardo **3 years** to paint (1495-1498). He experimented with an oil-tempera mix on dry plaster instead of traditional fresco — which is why it's been fading and requiring restoration for centuries.
- The **Duomo** has 3,400 statues, 135 spires, and a golden Madonna (Madonnina) at 108.5m. It took **579 years** to complete.
- The **Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II** (1877) is the oldest active shopping gallery in Italy. Locals believe spinning your heel on the mosaic bull's testicles brings good luck.
- During WWII, Milan was heavily bombed — but the **Last Supper wall was sandbagged and protected**, surviving the destruction of the entire refectory around it.

☐ **Where to Eat**

Place	Type	Cost
Luini (Via S. Antonio)	☐ Famous fried panzerotti	~€5
Miscusi (various)	☐ Modern pasta chain	~€12-18
Brera area	☐ Classic trattorias	~€20-35
Navigli	☐ Aperitivo (drink = free buffet)	~€10-15

✂ **Milan Safety**

- Medium risk.** Pickpocket hotspots: Duomo, Galleria, metro M1/M3, Centrale station
- ☐ **"Friendship bracelet" scam** — men tie bracelets on you in Duomo square, then demand payment. Shake them off.
 - ☐ **Fake charity petitions** — people ask you to sign, then demand €10-20. Just keep walking.
 - ☐ **Ticket touts outside Last Supper** — only use [cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it](#)

☐ **Day Timeline**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 09:00	☐ Breakfast + checkout	Harder Minerva, relaxed pace. No rush today.	CHF 10-15
09:33 → 12:48	☐ Interlaken → Milano	EC 61 EuroCity — via Spiez → Brig → Domodossola. Cross into Italy! Book Jul 2026.	From €23 ☐
12:48 → 13:30	☐ Drop bags	Hotel Demò (Via Tonale 14, 5 min from Centrale)	—
13:30 → 14:15	☐ Lunch	Near Santa Maria delle Grazie — quick pasta	€12-20
14:30 → 14:45	☐ Arrive SMG	Santa Maria delle Grazie — 30 min before slot	—
15:00 → 15:15	☐ THE LAST SUPPER	☐ Book late Jun/Jul! You get exactly 15 min with the world's most famous painting. Groups of 30 max. No photos with flash.	€15
15:30 → 15:50	☐ Walk	Via Torino → Piazza del Duomo (20 min)	FREE
16:00 → 17:00	☐ Duomo Rooftop	Stairs (€13) — 250 steps to the roof for golden hour views over the city. ☐ Last entry 18:00. Do this BEFORE the interior.	€13
17:00 → 18:00	☐ Duomo Interior	5 naves, 3,400 statues. See the Madonnina, the sundial, and St. Bartholomew's flayed skin statue.	€3
18:00 → 19:00	☐ Galleria + Terrace	Spin the bull's balls for luck! €12 for rooftop terrace or enjoy the glass dome from below for free.	FREE/€12
19:00+	☐ Dinner	Navigli — canals, aperitivo culture, atmospheric. Reserve!	€25-40

☐ **The Last Supper — What to Know**

TOPIC	DETAILS
☐ Location	Refectory of Santa Maria delle Grazie (Piazza di Santa Maria delle Grazie). M1 Cadorna or M2 Sant'Ambrogio.
☐ Booking	☐ URGENT: Quarterly release (Sep-Dec) ~late Jun/Jul at cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it . Sells out in hours . Extra tickets released Wednesdays 12:00 Italian time.
☐ Experience	15 minutes exactly. Groups of 30-40 enter every 15 min. Temperature/humidity controlled. No flash photography.
☐ The Art	Leonardo captured the moment Jesus says "one of you will betray me" — each apostle reacts differently. The composition is revolutionary: all perspective lines converge on Christ's head.
⚠ Scams	Only buy from cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it . Resellers charge €50-100 for the same €15 ticket.

DAY 05

Monday, October 5, 2026
☐ Hotel Palme · Via IV Novembre 10 (Old Town, bags held at reception)

☐ **About Cinque Terre**
The “Five Lands” — Monterosso, Vernazza, Corniglia, Manarola, and Riomaggiore — are five medieval fishing villages clinging to the rugged Ligurian coast. Since 1997, they’ve been a UNESCO World Heritage site. No cars reach the villages (except Monterosso). The **Sentiero Azzurro** (Blue Trail) connects all five with a 12km coastal hike. Each village has its own personality: Monterosso (beach resort), Vernazza (picturesque harbor), Corniglia (clifftop), Manarola (sunset views), Riomaggiore (steep and colorful). Local specialties: pesto alla genovese, trofie pasta, focaccia, and Sciacchetrà dessert wine.

☐ **Where to Eat**

Place	Type	Cost
Nessun Dorma (Vernazza)	☐ Sunset terrace ☐	~€15-20
Trofie al Pesto (any)	☐ Local specialty	~€12-18
Monterosso Harbour	☐ Seafood dinner	~€20-30
Pizza Kepris (Monterosso)	☐ Budget eats	~€5-8

- ✂ **CT Survival**
- **NO left luggage** at any CT station — confirm bag drop with hotel!
 - **Validate regional train tickets** in green machines before boarding (electronic tickets OK)
 - Sentiero Azzurro: proper shoes + water for the 90 min hike
 - **Monday:** Sforza Castle museums closed — but grounds + park open

☐ **Day Timeline**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 09:00	☐ Breakfast + checkout	Milan hotel, bags packed	—
09:00 → 09:45	☐ Sforza Castle grounds	Free access to Parco Sempione. Museums closed (Monday).	FREE
10:00 → 10:25	☐ Walk to Centrale	Metro M3 or 25 min walk	—
10:35 → 13:22	☐ Milan → Monterosso	Direct train, ~3h. Sit on the RIGHT for coastal views after Genova!	~€29
13:30 → 14:30	☐ Check-in + lunch	⚠ Confirm bag drop with hotel! No left luggage at stations.	€15-25

- ☐ **Afternoon — Pick One (they overlap!)**
- ☐ **OPTION B: Hike Monterosso → Vernazza** RECOMMENDED ☐
- | | | |
|---------------|--|---------------|
| 14:30 → 16:00 | Sentiero Azzurro hike — 90 min coastal trail with spectacular cliffside views into turquoise coves. Best done in afternoon light. | €7.50 CT Card |
| 16:00 → 16:30 | Explore Vernazza harbor — the most photogenic of the five villages. Climb the Doria tower for views. | FREE |
| 16:40 → 16:50 | ☐ CT Express back to Monterosso | CT Card |
- ☐ **OPTION A: Beach + Old Town**
- | | | |
|---------------|---|-------|
| 14:30 → 16:30 | Monterosso's sandy beach (the only proper beach in CT) + Old Town wander through narrow lanes | FREE |
| 16:30 → 17:30 | ☐ Gelato + passeggiata along the promenade | €5-10 |

Both options: 19:00+ seafood dinner at Monterosso harbour · ~€20-35

DAY 06

Tuesday, October 6, 2026
☐ Florence TBD (night 1 of 2, near SMN/Duomo)

☐ Key Sights Today

Morning: one last Cinque Terre hike (Monterosso → Vernazza, 90 min). Then the journey to Florence via La Spezia. Afternoon: Santa Croce (Michelangelo's tomb), San Miniato al Monte (closes 18:00 — go FIRST), then Piazzale Michelangelo for sunset (~18:11). This is a 14-hour day — but the sunset over Florence is worth every minute.

✂ Critical Timing

- **La Spezia:** Take 11:25 CT Express, NOT 11:45 (34 min buffer vs 14 min)
- **San Miniato FIRST** — closes 18:00. Then walk 2 min up to Piazzale for sunset.
- Hike only **Monterosso → Vernazza** (90 min), NOT Corniglia

☐ Day Timeline

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 08:30	☐ Breakfast	Monterosso — quick and efficient	—
08:30 → 10:00	☐ Morning Hike	Monterosso → Vernazza on Sentiero Azzurro. Morning light over the Ligurian Sea = ☐. 90 min, moderate difficulty.	€7.50 CT Card
10:00 → 10:20	☐ Vernazza	Last look at the colorful harbor	FREE
10:20 → 10:30	☐ CT Express	Vernazza → Monterosso (10 min)	CT Card
10:30 → 11:00	☐ Checkout	Pack bags, leave Monterosso	—
11:25 → 11:45	☐ Monterosso → La Spezia	34 min buffer before next train — find café, relax	CT Card
12:19 → 13:47	☐ La Spezia → Florence	Frecciarossa — 1h 28min to Firenze SMN. First taste of Italian high-speed rail!	~€20-30
14:00 → 14:30	☐ Check-in Florence	Hotel near SMN or Duomo	—
15:00 → 16:00	☐ Santa Croce	Tombs of Michelangelo, Galileo, Machiavelli . Donatello's Annunciation. Closes 17:30.	€12
16:00 → 16:40	☐ Ponte Vecchio	Photo stop at the jewelry-lined medieval bridge	FREE
17:00 → 17:45	☐ San Miniato al Monte	GO FIRST! Romanesque church with green-white marble facade. Plainsong chant at ~17:30. Closes 18:00 .	FREE
17:45 → 18:30	☐ Piazzale Michelangelo	SUNSET ~18:11 ☐ The classic Florence panorama — Duomo dome dominating the skyline. Bring a bottle of wine!	FREE
19:00+	☐ Dinner	Oltrarno district — authentic Tuscan reserve ahead	€20-35

DAY 07

Wednesday, October 7, 2026
☐ Cardinal of Florence · Borgo Pinti 5 (San Marco)

☐ **About Florence**

Florence (Firenze) is the cradle of the Renaissance. In the 15th century, the Medici family transformed this Tuscan city of 60,000 into the most culturally explosive place on Earth. In a single generation: Brunelleschi built the Dome (the largest masonry dome ever constructed), Donatello sculpted David, Masaccio revolutionized painting, and a young Leonardo da Vinci apprenticed in Verrocchio's workshop. Then Michelangelo, Raphael, and Botticelli followed. The **Uffizi Gallery** has the world's finest collection of Renaissance art. The **Accademia** houses Michelangelo's David (1504) — the most famous sculpture in history.

☐ **Did You Know?**

- Brunelleschi's Dome was built **without scaffolding** — he invented a revolutionary herringbone brick pattern that supports itself during construction.
- **David** was carved from a single block of Carrara marble that two earlier sculptors had **rejected** as flawed. Michelangelo was 26 when he started.
- The **Uffizi** (literally "offices") was originally built as Medici government offices in 1581 before becoming a museum.
- **Botticelli's Birth of Venus** in the Uffizi was **lost for 400 years** — considered pagan and inappropriate after the Renaissance until the 19th century.

☐ **Where to Eat**

Place	Type	Cost
All'Antico Vinaio	☐ Famous €8 sandwich	~€8
Mercato Centrale	☐ Upper floor food hall	~€10-18
Ditta Artigianale	☑ Specialty coffee	~€4-6
Oltrarno	☐ Tuscan dinner	~€20-35

✂ **Florence Safety**

- Medium-high.** Top pickpocket: Duomo, Santa Croce, packed museums
- ☐ **Bracelet scam** — aggressive men near Duomo tie bracelets, demand payment. Shake them off.
 - ☐ **Gold ring scam** — someone "finds" a ring near you, accomplice lifts your bag while you look
 - ☐ **Unofficial taxis** — use only white taxis with meters

☐ **Day Timeline — Big Art Day!** ☐

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:15 → 10:15	☐ UFFIZI GALLERY	First slot = least crowded. See: Botticelli (Birth of Venus, Spring), Leonardo (Annunciation), Caravaggio (Medusa), Raphael (Madonna of the Goldfinch). ⚠ Book Aug-Sep!	~€40
10:30 → 11:15	☐ ACCADEMIA — DAVID	Michelangelo's David! 45 min is enough for the David room and the Hall of Prisoners. Pre-book 10:30.	~€12
11:30 → 12:30	☐ BRUNELLESCHI'S DOME	463 steps to the top! No elevator. The climb is tight, narrow, and spiraling — but you emerge inches from the dome frescoes with a confining view of Florence. Pre-book!	€30
12:30 → 13:00	☐ Duomo Interior	Free entry. Dress code: shoulders + knees. See Vasari's Last Judgment fresco inside the dome.	FREE
13:00 → 14:00	☐ LUNCH @ Mercato Centrale	Upper floor food hall — 20+ stalls, fresh pasta, pizza, truffle, wine. €10-18 gets you a feast.	€10-18
14:00 → 15:30	☐ Oltrarno Walk	Cross Ponte Vecchio → Palazzo Pitti courtyard → Santo Spirito square → Via Maggio. The quieter, artisan side of Florence.	FREE/€5
15:30 → 16:30	☐ San Lorenzo Market	Leather goods, souvenirs. Return via Ponte Vecchio.	FREE
17:00 → 18:00	☐ San Miniato (backup)	If you missed it Oct 6 — closes 18:00. Plainsong at 17:30.	FREE
19:00+	☐ Final Florence Dinner	Try Bistecca alla Fiorentina in Oltrarno. Reserve ahead. Ditta Artigianale for coffee.	€20-35

☐ **Uffizi Gallery — Don't Miss These Rooms**

ROOM	MASTERPIECE	WHAT TO KNOW
Room 10-14	Botticelli — Birth of Venus, Spring	The most famous room. Birth of Venus (1486) was revolutionary — the first large-scale non-religious nude since antiquity.
Room 15	Leonardo da Vinci — Annunciation, Adoration of the Magi	Annunciation (1472) was Leonardo's first major work. Note the angel's wings — he later repainted them.
Room 25	Michelangelo — Holy Family (Doni Tondo)	The only easel painting by Michelangelo still in Florence. Circular frame is original.
Room 90	Caravaggio — Medusa, Bacchus	Medusa painted on a wooden shield. Caravaggio used his own face as the model for Medusa's head.

DAY 08

Thursday, October 8, 2026
☐ Rome TBD (4 nights, same hotel)

☐ **About Siena**
Siena is a perfectly preserved medieval city — a rival to Florence in artistry, politics, and pride. In the 14th century, Siena was Florence's great enemy. The shell-shaped **Piazza del Campo** is one of Europe's greatest squares. Twice a year, it hosts the **Palio**, a bareback horse race that lasts 90 seconds (but the rivalry lasts all year). The Siena **Duomo** has an extraordinary mosaic floor that took 200 years to complete (covered for most of the year — you might catch it if October exposure allows). The Piccolomini Library has frescoes by Pinturicchio that rival the Sistine Chapel.

- ✂ **Key Tips**
- Bus 131R from Florence Autostazione (behind SMN). Arrive **10 min early** — buses fill up.
 - Backup: regional train via Empoli
 - Uphill walk back to bus stop for return — allow extra time
 - Frecciarossa: **Book Jul 2026** for best prices (from €14.90)

☐ **Day Timeline**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
07:00 → 08:00	☐ Breakfast + checkout	Leave luggage at Florence hotel	—
08:30 → 09:45	☐ Bus 131R → Siena	From Autostazione behind SMN (not the main station). 1h 15min through Tuscan hills.	€7-9
09:45 → 10:00	☐ Piazza del Campo	Downhill walk from bus stop (5 min). The shell-shaped square — medieval masterpiece.	FREE
10:00 → 10:30	☐ Piazza del Campo	The heart of Siena. Torre del Mangia towers above. The Palio is run around this square.	FREE
10:30 → 11:30	☐ Siena Duomo	Mosaic floor ☐ — 56 panels depicting biblical and allegorical scenes. Also: Piccolomini Library with Pinturicchio's exquisite frescoes.	€10-15
11:30 → 12:15	☐ Torre del Mangia	400 steps for panoramic Siena + Tuscan countryside views	€10
12:15 → 12:45	☐ Quick lunch	Pici cacio e pepe (Siena's thick spaghetti) or panino	€10-15
13:30 → 14:45	☐ Bus → Florence	⚠ Arrive 13:20 for 13:30 bus. Buses fill up. Walk uphill takes time!	€7-9
14:45 → 15:10	☐ Collect luggage	Walk back to hotel + SMN station	—
16:00 → 17:28	☐ Frecciarossa → Rome	Firenze SMN → Roma Termini. 1h 28min at 300km/h through Tuscany. Book Jul 2026!	From €14.90
17:30 → 18:00	☐ Check-in Rome	Settle into home base for 4 nights	—
19:00 → 20:00	☐ Trevi Fountain (night)	Lit up after dark ☐ — fewer crowds, magic atmosphere	FREE

DAY 09

Friday, October 9, 2026
☐ Rome — same hotel

☐ About Vatican City

Vatican City is the world's smallest independent state (44 hectares, ~800 citizens) and the spiritual center of 1.3 billion Catholics. **St. Peter's Basilica** (built 1506-1626) is the largest church in the world — conceived by Pope Julius II, designed by Bramante, Raphael, and Michelangelo (who designed the dome at age 72). The **Vatican Museums** contain one of the world's greatest art collections, amassed by popes over 500 years. The **Sistine Chapel** ceiling (1508-1512) is Michelangelo's masterpiece — 500m² of fresco depicting nine scenes from Genesis, including the iconic Creation of Adam.

☐ Did You Know?

- **St. Peter's** is built on the site where St. Peter (the first pope) was crucified and buried — his tomb is directly under the main altar.
- The **Dome climb** is 551 steps (elevator takes you 231 steps up, then 320 steps). The view from the top is worth every step.
- The **Sistine Chapel** ceiling was painted by Michelangelo **standing up** (not lying down as commonly believed). It took 4 years, damaging his eyesight permanently.
- The **Vatican Museums** have 7km of corridors. If you spent 30 seconds on each piece, it would take **12 years** to see everything.

☐ Where to Eat (Rome)

Place	Type	Cost
Trastevere	☐ Authentic Roman dinner	~€20-35
Pastificio	☐ €4 takeaway pasta	~€4
Near Vatican	☐ Quick lunch	~€12-20
Gelateria del Teatro	☐ Artisanal gelato	~€4-7

✂ Vatican Scams — HIGH ALERT

- ☐ **"Official ticket touts"** — only use tickets.museivaticani.va. Fake staff at the entrance sell invalid tickets.
- ☐ **"Skip the line" scammers** — they claim to work for the Vatican. They don't.
- ☐ **Papal blessing scam** — fake "specially blessed" items sold for €20-50. Official shop: minimal cost.
- ☐ **Pickpocket density:** Metro line A (Ottaviano station for Vatican). Zip pockets, bag in front.

☐ Day Timeline — Vatican (closed Sun — must be today!)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
06:30 → 07:00	☐ Early breakfast	Hotel or nearby café. Start early for empty St. Peter's.	—
07:00 → 07:30	☐ St. Peter's Basilica	Opens 07:00 — arrive right at opening for zero queue. FREE entrance. See: Pietà by Michelangelo (his only signed work), Bernini's baldachin, the confession of St. Peter.	FREE
07:30 → 08:15	☐ St. Peter's Dome	Opens 07:30 (Oct hours — NOT 07:00!). 551 steps to the top. Elevator €15 (saves 231 steps) or stairs €10.⬆ DO IT EARLY — no queue!	€10/€15
08:15 → 08:45	☐ Crypt/Grottoes	Tomb of St. Peter, tombs of popes beneath the basilica	FREE
09:00 → 09:30	☐ Castel Sant'Angelo ext.	Walk along the Tiber — Hadrian's mausoleum (139 AD), later a papal fortress	FREE
09:30 → 10:30	☐ Via della Conciliazione	The grand boulevard leading to St. Peter's → Piazza Navona walk	FREE
10:30 → 11:30	☐ Piazza Navona	Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers (1651) — representing the Nile, Ganges, Danube, and Río de la Plata	FREE
11:30 → 12:00	☐ Pantheon	€5 entry. The most perfectly preserved Roman building. The dome's oculus is 9m wide and open to the sky — rain falls through.	€5
12:00 → 13:00	☐ Lunch near Vatican	Quick pasta near the Museums entrance	€12-20
13:00 → 17:30	☐ VATICAN MUSEUMS	4.5 hours! Pre-book 13:00 slot. See: Sistine Chapel (last 30 min), Raphael Rooms, Gallery of Maps, Belvedere Torso, Laocoön. Book Aug-Sep!	~€22
17:45 → 18:15	☐ St. Peter's Square	Evening light on Bernini's colonnade — 284 columns embracing the square	FREE
18:30 → 19:00	☐ Ponte Sisto	Cross the Tiber to Trastevere — the most Roman of neighborhoods	—
19:00+	☐ Dinner in Trastevere	Reserve ahead. Narrow cobblestone alleys, ivy-covered restaurants, authentic Roman cuisine: cacio e pepe, carbonara, amatriciana.	€25-40

DAY 10

Saturday, October 10, 2026
☐ Rome — same hotel

☐ About Ancient Rome

For over 1,000 years, Rome was the center of the Western world. The **Colosseum** (80 AD) held 50,000 spectators for gladiator battles and mock naval fights. The **Roman Forum** was the political, religious, and commercial heart of the Republic — where Cicero spoke, Caesar was assassinated (in the Curia of Pompey nearby), and emperors built triumphal arches. **Palatine Hill** is where Rome was founded (753 BC) — emperors built their palaces here (the word "palace" comes from Palatine). The **Borghese Gallery** houses Bernini's most sensual sculptures and Caravaggio's most dramatic paintings.

☐ Did You Know?

- The **Colosseum** could be flooded for mock naval battles — 50,000 spectators watched ships fight. It had 80 entrances and could empty in 10 minutes.
- **Bernini carved Apollo and Daphne** (Borghese) at age 22 — the marble transforms into leaves so realistically you can see through it.
- The **Roman Forum** was buried under 10m of earth for 1,000 years — farmers called it "Campo Vaccino" (Cow Field).
- **Trevi Fountain** (1762) uses 80,000m³ of water daily — all from the Acqua Vergine aqueduct, built in 19 BC. Throwing a coin over your LEFT shoulder guarantees your return to Rome.

✂ Ancient Rome Scams

- ☐ **Colosseum queue helpers** — "skip the line" scammers for €50. You already have a timed ticket from colosseo.it.
- ☐ **Gladiator photos** — costumed gladiators charge €20-50 per photo. Take your own pictures of them from a distance.
- ☐ **Trevi Fountain: pickpocket central** — selfie sticks, crowded, phones in pockets.

☐ Day Timeline

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:30 → 10:30	☐ COLOSSEUM	First slot = cooler + less crowded! Pre-book Sep 2026. Arena floor upgrade (€24) lets you stand where gladiators fought. ☐ Worth it. Your ticket also covers Forum + Palatine.	€18/€24
10:30 → 12:00	☐ Roman Forum + Palatine	1.5h — hit the highlights: Arch of Titus (celebrating the sack of Jerusalem, 70 AD), Via Sacra , Senate House , Temple of Caesar (where his body was cremated), Palatine Hill (Domus Augustana imperial palace).	Incl.
12:00 → 12:15	Walk → Piazza Venezia	Via dei Fori Imperiali — looking down on the excavations	FREE
12:15 → 12:45	☐ Trevi Fountain (day)	Throw a coin over your LEFT shoulder with your RIGHT hand. ☐	FREE
12:45 → 13:45	☐ Lunch	In the Trevi-Spanish Steps area	€12-20
14:00 → 14:40	☐ Walk to Borghese	Through Villa Borghese park — Rome's green lung, 80 hectares	FREE
14:40	Arrive Borghese	⚠ 20 min before slot! No late entry — strict. Max 360 people per 2-hour slot.	—
15:00 → 17:00	☐ BORGHESE GALLERY	Book Jul-Aug 2026. MUST SEE: Bernini's Apollo and Daphne (the most dynamic marble sculpture ever), Rape of Proserpina (marble flesh gives way under Pluto's fingers), Caravaggio's David with Goliath , Boy with Fruit Basket . 2hr limit — go straight to the most famous rooms.	~€18
17:30 → 19:00	☐ Dolce Vita Walk	Via Veneto → Spanish Steps. The famous street from Fellini's La Dolce Vita. Climb the Spanish Steps for sunset over Rome.	FREE
19:30+	☐ Dinner	Trastevere or Campo de' Fiori — Roman classics	€25-40

DAY 11 & 12

Sunday-Monday, October 11-12, 2026
☐ Rome → ➔ Fly Home

☐ **Last Day in Rome**
This is your decompression day. No big museums, no timed tickets. Just Rome, relaxed. The **Aventine Keyhole** is one of Rome's best secrets: look through the keyhole of the Knights of Malta gate and see St. Peter's Dome perfectly framed. The **Orange Garden** (Giardino degli Aranci) on the Aventine has the best free sunset view. The keyhole queues up at sunset — go in the afternoon instead.

- **Departure Day Tips**
- **Leonardo Express** Termini → FCO: every 15 min, 32 min, €14. Reliable.
 - At FCO by 10:00 for 12:40 flight — 2h 40min is comfortable.
 - **Final dinner:** Splurge — you've earned it. Reserve ahead.

☐ **Day 11 — Sunday, Oct 11: Relaxed Rome**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 09:00	☐ Breakfast + checkout	Store luggage at hotel. Last day, make it count.	—
09:30 → 10:00	☐ Trevi Fountain (morning)	Fewer people! Morning light on the marble — get the photos you couldn't get at night.	FREE
10:00 → 11:00	☐ Spanish Steps	Piazza di Spagna, Via Condotti shopping window-gazing	FREE
11:00 → 12:00	☑ Last caffè	People-watching at a sidewalk café. One last espresso.	€5-10
13:00 → 14:30	☐ Aventine Keyhole	Knights of Malta — look through the keyhole for a perfectly framed St. Peter's Dome. Then Orange Garden (Giardino degli Aranci) — the best free view of Rome ☐.	FREE
16:00 → 17:00	☐ Last passeggiata	One final walk through Rome. Piazza del Popolo? Trastevere? Your choice.	FREE
17:00 → 18:00	☐ Collect luggage	Back to the hotel	—
19:00+	☐ FINAL DINNER	Splurge! Reserve the best table in Trastevere. Cacio e pepe, carbonara, amatriciana — finish with a limoncello. You've earned this.	€30-45

➔ **Day 12 — Monday, Oct 12: Departure**

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
07:30 → 08:00	☐ Breakfast	One last cappuccino (breakfast only — never after 11am!)	—
08:00 → 09:00	☐ Last souvenirs	Final walk, last-minute shopping	—
09:20 → 09:52	☐ Leonardo Express	Termini → FCO. Every 15 min, 32 min. €14 — buy at station machines.	€14
10:00 → 12:40	☐ Check-in + Security	At gate by 11:45	—
12:40	➔ GF26 → BAH	Arrive Bahrain 19:20 · Layover 22:45 · GF56 → BOM	Booked
05:10+1	☐ Arrive Mumbai ☐	12 days, 8 cities, 2 countries. The trip of a lifetime. ☐☐☐☐	—

APPENDIX

11 Corrections Applied (v3 → v4)

#	ISSUE	V3 (WRONG)	V4 (FIXED)
1	Jungfraujoch day	Oct 4 morning (1h 15min)	Oct 3 afternoon (3h)
2	Pilatus start time	14:30 (too late)	12:00 start or choose relaxed
3	CT activities	Beach + hike as sequential	Clear A/B — mutually exclusive
4	CT hike	Vernazza → Corniglia (3h won't fit)	Monterosso → Vernazza (90 min)
5	La Spezia connection	11:45 → 12:19 (14 min buffer)	11:25 → 12:19 (34 min buffer)
6	San Miniato (Oct 6)	18:45 (after closing)	17:00-17:45 (before Piazzale)
7	San Miniato (Oct 7)	17:30-18:30 (after close)	17:00-18:00 (within hours)
8	St. Peter's Dome open	07:00 (wrong Oct hours)	07:30
9	St. Peter's Dome close	18:00 (wrong Oct hours)	17:00
10	Last Supper booking	"June 2026"	Late Jun/Jul (quarterly)
11	Swiss pass	Travel Pass (CHF 254)	Half Fare Card (CHF 120)

Critical Warnings

- Last Supper: ONLY cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it (official €15)
- CT stations have NO left luggage — confirm bag drop with hotel
- Siena bus 131R: arrive 10 min early — buses fill up
- Borghese Gallery: 20 min early, NO late entry
- INSIDE FIVE: register 24h before + upload passport
- Vatican Museums closed Sunday — our Oct 9 visit is correct
- Make dinner reservations for nightlife areas

Quick Tips

- Italian espresso at the bar = €1-2. Sitting = €4-7
- Aperitivo: buy a drink, free buffet = dinner!
- Coop/Migros in Switzerland: €5-8 ready meals
- Florence church dress code: shoulders + knees covered
- Swiss Half Fare Card: buy on swissrailways.com
- SBB app: load QR code, buy 50% off tickets per trip
- Trains: Trenitalia advance booking = lowest prices